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Nutmeg presses a seed into the garden bed. She checks before lunch. Nothing. She checks after lunch. Still nothing. Perhaps she should dig it up and see what is wrong.



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Hen-Berry pats the soil back into place. “Give it a little water,” she says. “Then leave it tucked in.” Nutmeg puts down her trowel. Waiting feels harder than digging.



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Each morning Nutmeg checks the soil and waters when it needs a drink. On the seventh morning, she spots a green sprout lifting a crumb of earth. “You were there all along!”



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That evening Nutmeg sits beside her little garden. The sprout is hardly taller than a pebble, but she can find it at once. Tomorrow she will bring water, not her trowel.

Questions for Nutmeg’s Garden Morning

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1

Talk together: Why does Nutmeg want to dig up the seed?

Page 2

Talk together: Why might leaving the seed alone help it?

Page 3

Talk together: What did Nutmeg do while she waited for the sprout?

Page 4

Talk together: What does Nutmeg plan to do differently next time?

After reading 1

Why will Nutmeg bring water rather than dig up the seed next time?

After reading 2

Why did Hen-Berry cover the soil again?

Answers (fold under before reading)

After reading 1: She has seen that a seed can grow while it is hidden. The sprout appeared after she cared for the soil and gave it time.

After reading 2: To leave the seed tucked in while it grew.